

# News Weekly

## 59,000-year-old tooth offers a rare glimpse into how Neanderthals handled a medical problem

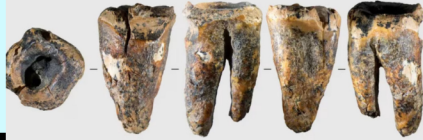
Researchers have discovered evidence of the earliest known dental intervention in human history within a Siberian cave.

An adult Neanderthal molar, recovered from Chagyrskaya Cave in the Altai Mountains, features a deep, irregular hole that reaches the tooth's inner pulp chamber. While the chasm appeared to be a painful cavity, microscopic scans and tool-use experiments published in PLOS One suggest the tooth was intentionally manipulated.

Microscopic scratches surrounding the hole indicate that the individual—or a peer—used fine-pointed stone tools to drill out the infection. Wear patterns show the Neanderthal continued to use the tooth following the procedure, suggesting the surgery was successful.

"What amazed me was how intuitively the person understood the source of the pain and realized it could be removed," said lead author Alisa Zubova of the Russian Academy of Sciences. "We have never encountered anything like this before among Neanderthals."

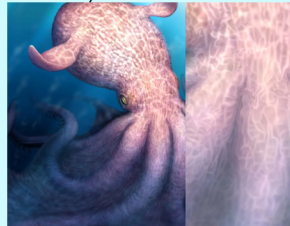
The find suggests these early humans possessed sophisticated medical knowledge, including the ability to identify infections and craft specialized tools to alleviate physical suffering (Source: CNN).



## Giant, kraken-like octopuses may have ruled the Cretaceous deep

The kraken, a legendary sea monster, finds its real-life counterpart in the ancient gigantic octopuses that roamed the oceans millions of years ago. Fossilized jaws suggest that these creatures could grow up to 19 meters in length, positioning them as apex predators during the Cretaceous Period. Due to their soft-bodied structure, fossil evidence is relatively scarce, primarily comprising beak-like jaws discovered in Japan and Canada.

Researchers have analyzed 15 fossilized jaws and identified two distinct species: \*Nanaimoteuthis jeltzkyi\* and the larger \*N. haggarti\*, both believed to be early finned octopuses. Notably, the lower jaw of \*N. haggarti\* exceeds the size of that of today's giant squid. These ancient cephalopods may have been among the largest invertebrates ever, potentially rivaling formidable marine predators such as mosasaurs. (Source: Science News)



## "Tourist Arrested for Throwing Rock at Beloved Endangered Seal 'Lani' in Maui"

A tourist was arrested in Hawaii after being recorded throwing a coconut-sized rock at "Lani," a beloved endangered Hawaiian monk seal off a Maui beach. Igor Mykhaylovych Lytvynchuk, 38, from Washington, is charged with harassing a protected animal. He was arrested near Seattle and was to appear in court there.

A witness recorded the incident in Lahaina, a community affected by wildfires in 2023. The video showed the man aiming and throwing the rock at the seal, narrowly missing its head but causing it to change behavior. When confronted, he reportedly said he didn't care and could afford fines.

Maui Mayor Richard Bissen stated that the charges emphasize that cruelty toward protected wildlife is unacceptable. Lani symbolizes hope and healing after the fires, Bissen said. Lytvynchuk faces up to a year in prison per charge and fines under the Endangered Species Act and Marine Mammal Protection Act.

(Source: CNN)



## Giant robots battle it out in Detroit's Robowar

In a Detroit church, where the usual sermon is replaced by the clank of metal, performers in mech suits dive into thrilling robot battles for an audience safely tucked behind bullet-proof glass. Art Cartwright, the mastermind behind both the church and The Interactive Combat League, dishes out the adrenaline-pumping show, Robowar, featuring towering nine-foot "robots" that unleash a barrage of projectiles. While Detroit boasts the crown in robotics, these performers bring to life a cultural fantasy, drawing inspiration from tales and flicks like Richard Matheson's "Steel" and the movie "Real Steel." Since blasting off last summer, Robowar has packed its 572-seat auditorium to the brim and is all revved up to launch online interactive fights, letting viewers control the action with virtual tokens.

(Source: NPR)



## A low-cost rotavirus test could save childrens' lives in Nigeria

In Nigerian hospitals and across sub-Saharan Africa, children with severe diarrhea arrive daily, often without a clear diagnosis of the cause. Virologist Margaret Oluwatoyin Japhet at Obafemi Awolowo University is developing a rapid diagnostic kit to identify the cause of diarrhea in children, particularly focusing on rotavirus, which is a leading cause globally. Despite vaccines, rotavirus remains a significant threat, especially in sub-Saharan Africa, causing over 100,000 deaths in children under five annually.

Japhet's low-cost diagnostic kit can detect rotavirus without the need for complex machinery or extensive training, making it suitable for resource-limited settings. The kit uses cotton swabs and nanobeads coated with antibodies which turn blue to indicate the presence of rotavirus, offering a simple and almost mess-free solution. This innovation could revolutionize diarrheal disease surveillance and outbreak response in areas lacking laboratory facilities. (Source: Science News)



# Riddle

I slide between solid and  
gas; skip the liquid stop  
entirely.

## Strands



## Herby Pesto Pasta

### Ingredients:

- Your choice of pasta
- Fresh basil
- Fresh parsley
- Garlic
- Pine nuts
- Parmesan cheese
- Olive oil
- Salt
- Pepper
- Optional: Extra Parmesan and fresh herbs for garnish
- Cook your choice of pasta according to package instructions until al dente.
- In a food processor, combine fresh basil, parsley, garlic, pine nuts, and Parmesan cheese.
- Pulse until finely chopped, then slowly drizzle in olive oil while blending until smooth.
- Season with salt and pepper to taste, adjusting flavors as needed.
- Toss the cooked pasta with the herby pesto until evenly coated.
- Serve immediately, garnished with extra Parmesan and fresh herbs if desired.

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